

theatre system depends largely on the size of the room. There is another aspect that you need to keep in mind while buying a home theatre system. Do you want to buy a readymade all-in-one system or assemble one? In case of the latter, ensure that each component you buy is compatible with the other, or else sound quality will drop.

If you wish to assemble a system, list your requirements on that basis and then purchase the components. If, for instance, you already have a 74cm TV, then all you need to do is purchase a DVD player, speakers and audio/video receiver. When selecting the DVD player, you have various options. You can go for a DVD player that has the record feature or you can buy one that has Blu-ray support. With the speakers, you need to check if your audio/video receiver will support it. Speakers for a home theatre system come in the following format—5.1, 6.1 or 7.1. Check if your audio/video receiver supports these formats.

Let's look at what is currently available in the market and then understand the various features so that you can make the right decision while buying a home theatre system.

What's available?

Different companies like Sony, Philips and Panasonic manufacture various kinds of home theatre systems. The selection criteria depends on the size of your room, because the performance of the system depends highly on it. The cost of a home theatre system ranges from around Rs 12,000 to as high as Rs 50,000, or even more. Home theatre systems come with various combinations—basic home theatre systems, home theatre systems with tall speakers, wireless home theatre systems, etc.

The basic. These are the most common and their price ranges from Rs 12,000–Rs 20,000. They comprise speakers, the audio/video receiver and the sub-woofer. The features that you can expect in the basic home theatre system are the S-Master digital ampli-

Sony DAV-DZ390



**Price
Rs 19,990**

- Output power - 1000W
- USB port for direct video and audio play from thumb drive
- S-Master amplifier
- Bass Boost function
- Sound support - Dolby Pro Logic/Dolby Pro Logic II, Dolby Digital, DTS
- Karaoke
- Tuning range (FM) 87.5 ~ 108.0 MHz
- HDMI (1080P) with BRAVIA Sync
- Warranty: One year

fier, universal serial bus (USB) movie playback, high-definition multimedia interface (HDMI) output, support for both Digital Dolby and DTS formats, a 5.1 surround sound environment and more. The USB movie playback supports MP3, Wav, ACC, JPEG audio format and the DivX and MPEG4 video formats. The total output power of the basic home theatre system ranges from 500W-800W. Apart from the features, the price also depends on its design. In this category you'll also find designs that are sleek enough to be mounted on the wall.

With tall speakers. These are basically for big rooms and have a higher total output power. The cost of home theatre system in this category ranges from Rs 25,000-Rs 35,000. The features are almost the same as that of the basic version, but the total output power is 1000W, which offers good sound quality in bigger rooms. The speakers are tall and can be placed at different

corners of the room.

Wireless. These are sophisticated and the prize starts from Rs 45,000. The main attraction of this system is the wireless speakers. These systems are for large halls as the speakers can be placed at different corners such that they cover the entire hall. The basic features of this range are 1000W total output power, S-AIR surround wireless speakers, HDMI cables, USB movie playback, etc.

Features to look for

Televisions. The most important device of a home theatre system is the output device—TV. The size of the TV is also important if you wish to experience the real movie theatre experience at home. It should be a minimum of 74 cm, and the bigger the size of the TV, the better the 'theatre' experience. There should also be the appropriate viewing distance, which is about two times the width of the TV screen. In other words, if you have a 86cm TV, you should sit 215 cms (about 7 feet) away from the screen.

Surround sound. Sound that feels like it's in 'real time' and coming from all directions can be termed as surround sound. The main difference between a movie theatre and TV is surround sound, for which you require a minimum of three speakers

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